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van rysel rcr road bike ag2r team edition 2024 1

2024 Van Rysel road bikes and kit for newly-named Decathlon AG2R La Mondiale unveiled (and the prices aren't too outrageous)

● AG2R riders will be sat atop bikes from Decathlon's in-house performance road cycling brand in 2024, and the RCR road bike in its team spec will be available in the new year for around £8.5k

by JACK SEXTON
UPDATED TUE

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New Van Rysel pro team [road bikes](#) and time trial bikes have been seen for the first time at the unveiling of the newly-named Decathlon AG2R La Mondiale team, previously known as AG2R Citroën Team, ahead of the 2024 season. AG2R will ride Van Rysel RCR road bikes, XCR time trial bikes and new Van Rysel kit and accessories (saying goodbye to brown bib shorts in the process), with all the bikes and gear available to buy on Decathlon's UK site and abroad from 2024 onwards.



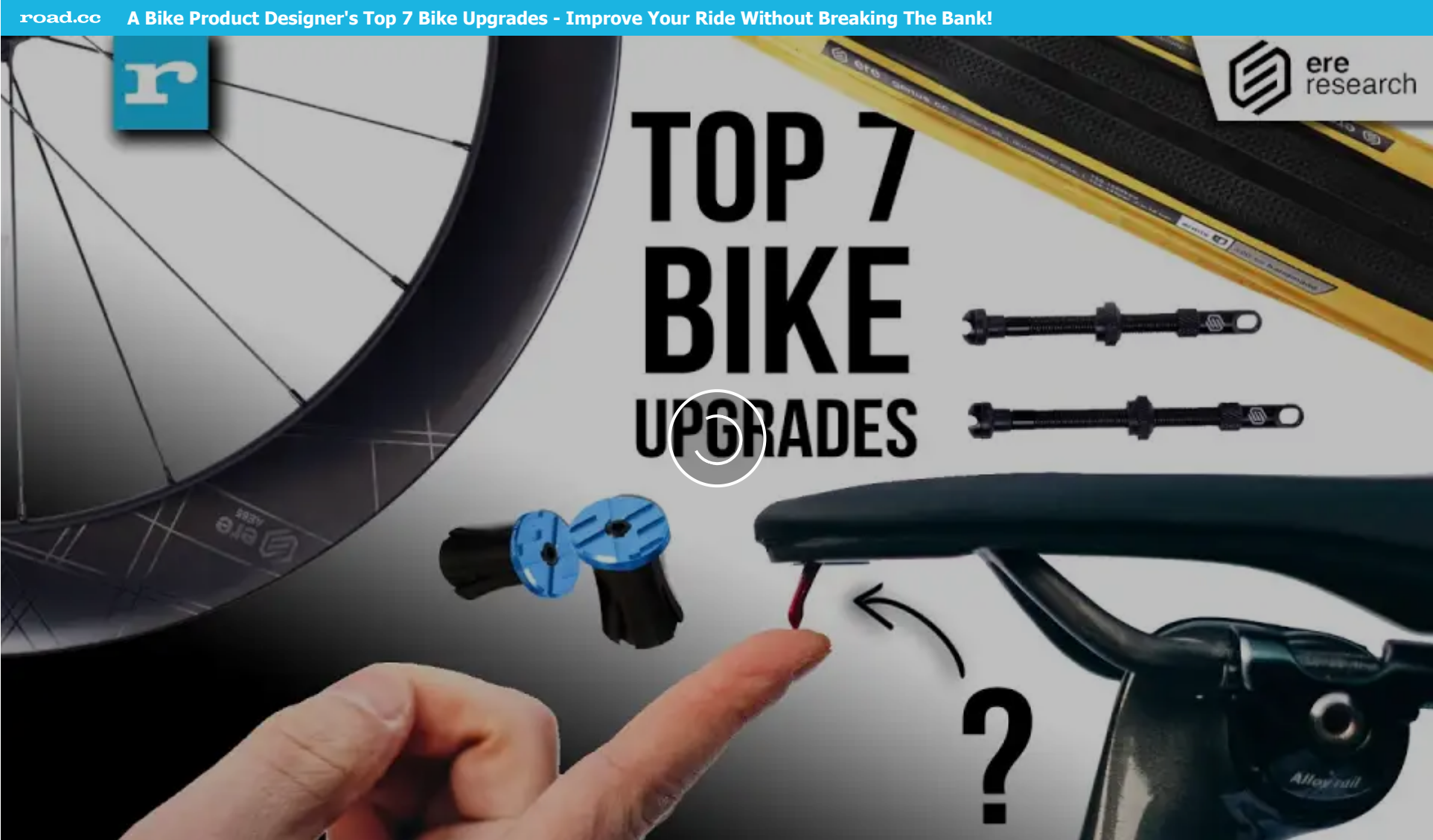
A prototype of the new XCR time trial bike was first seen at the start of this year

The news isn't exactly a secret, with a Van Rysel time trial bike prototype sparking rumours that Decathlon was coming back to the World Tour way back in January, and a Decathlon representative [also telling us that seven new Van Rysel bikes would launch in the new year](#). Further leaks confirmed the team partnership and new bikes in September, with AG2R dropping BMC as its bike supplier from 1st January 2024.

[> Confirmed: AG2R will ride Decathlon's Van Rysel bikes in 2024](#)

The headline sponsor news was a bit of a surprise, and this is the first time we've seen the new team liveried bikes and kit. Decathlon last had World Tour representation in the mid-2000s, with Jaan Kirsipuu bagging the last of his Tour de France stage wins on a Decathlon Penta Pro in 2004 (read all about the bike [in this edition of Bike At Bedtime](#)).





A slick presentation fronted by Decathlon bigwigs assured us that no expense was spared when developing the new RCR road and XCR time trial bikes, with the brand taking prototypes into the wind tunnel and enlisting the help of Swiss Side - who are supplying the AG2R team's wheels - to refine aerodynamics. The integrated cockpits have been developed and manufactured with Italian component specialists Deda, are brand new and are specific to the RCR and XCR bikes.

The RCR is very much a bike to rule them all, hitting the 6.8kg UCI limit while being aero AF according to Decathlon's head of product development. The XCR is the only road bike available

Van Rysel RCR Pro frame and fork
Swiss Side Hadron² wheels
Continental GP5000 tyres
Shimano Dura-Ace Di2 groupset
Deda/Van Rysel integrated cockpit
Fizik saddles
Look Keo pedals
Wahoo Elemnt bolt computers
Elite bottle cages



There are also new shades and three new helmets that the team will use from January '24. The helmets are called the RCR (road), FCR (aero road) and XCR (time trial), and here are the prices and colourways:

RCR Road (black): £64.99
RCR Road Mips (white or blue): £84.99
FCR (white): £99.99
FCR Mips (black): £119.99
XCR time trial helmet (black): £199.99

The shades are called the Performance 900 and Performance 900 Light, available in numerous spec levels and price points. Here's a summary:

Performance 900 CAT3: £59.99
Performance 900 Photochromatic £89.99
Performance 900 Electro photochromatic lens: £249.99
Performance 900 Light CAT3: £59.99
Performance 900 Light with exchangeable lens pack: £89.99
Performance 900 Light with exchangeable Zeiss lens pack: £149.99
Performance 900 Light Transition for triathlon: £149.99

All the helme



Bike prices and availability



None of the new bikes and kit are actually on the Decathlon UK website to buy yet (there were some RCR Rival AXS bikes earlier in the year and the listing [is still online](#), but we're told they sold out "in minutes"), and as I was typing this article the brand managers worked diligently to get some more info. That happened just before we left Decathlon's HQ in Lille, and the prices of the bikes will be as follows:

RCR Rival AXS: £4,299.99

RCR Force AXS: £4,999.99

RCR Pro CF Disc Ultegra Di2: £5,499.99

RCR Pro SRAM Red eTap: £8,499.99

RCR Pro Shimano Dura-Ace Di2: £8,499.99

XCR Ultegra Di2 TT bike: £5,999.99

That tallies with what we reported in [this September edition of Tech of the Week](#), although we're now told that among the Dura-Ace models, there will also be a limited number of exact team replica editions available to buy. Assuming it's also priced at £8.5k, that's considerably less than what you'd fork out for some top-tier bikes being ridden by other World Tour teams.

The RCR Pro frameset is also the same in all configurations, so if you were to buy the Ultegra Di2 model, it's still the same frame the pros are using. The standard RCR has a slightly less premium carbon layup, and weighs around 40g more than the RCR Pro frame, which is said to be 790g.



And in other news...



Au revoir brown shorts

We've already reported most of this [on our live blog this morning](#), but just to round up the team news: AG2R Citroën Team has now become Decathlon AG2R La Mondiale Team, with the French retail giant now on board as the French team's headline sponsor from 1st January 2024. AG2R's World Tour team has a roster of 28 riders, the development team has 10 riders and the U19 team will have 15 riders (all are men's teams currently).

Six new riders have joined the senior team, including Sam Bennett and Victor Lafay, and the binning off of the aesthetically-divisive brown [bib shorts](#) from the new team kit ensemble may be a relief for the newbies... or they may be disappointed, such is the divisiveness of brown cycling shorts.



There was a lot of talk about "democratising sport" from Decathlon's CEO Barbara Martin Coppola at the presentation, something that perhaps doesn't exactly dovetail with becoming the title sponsors of an elite road cycling team; but this partnership is part of a wider strategy for Decathlon to increase its presence in the cycling sector, so we were told.

Decathlon also boasted that it wants to become "one of the top five global cycling brands" during its five-year partnership with AG2R. It's a lofty ambition, but one that's probably not out of reach at all for the largest retailer of sporting goods in the world.



How will Sam Bennett and Co get on with their new steeds? We'll look forward to the 2024 season to find out, and have also been promised a new RCR bike, some shades and helmets to review ourselves in the new year...

♥

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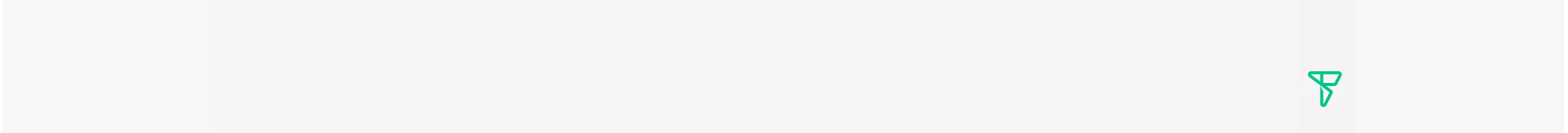
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VAN RYSEL
- VAN RYSEL RCR
- DECATHLON
- AG2R CITROËN TEAM



Jack Sexty

Arriving at road.cc in 2017 via 220 Triathlon Magazine, Jack dipped his toe in most jobs on the site and over at eBikeTips before being named the new editor of road.cc in 2020, much to his surprise. His cycling life began during his students days, when he cobbled together a few hundred quid off the back of a hard winter selling hats (long story) and bought his first road bike - a Trek 1.1 that was quickly relegated to winter steed, before it was sadly pinched a few years later. Creatively replacing it with a Trek 1.2, Jack mostly rides this bike around local cycle paths nowadays, but when he wants to get the racer out and be competitive his preferred events are time trials, sportives, triathlons and pogo sticking - the latter being another long story.



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11 comments

THREADED



peted76 | 5 days ago

These look ace value to be fair.. with all the articles and conversations about the higher costs of bikes since brexit/covid/cost of living etc.. having a world tour ready bike on sale for 23% cheaper than a Giant TCR DuraAce DI2 or 35% cheaper than a similar Specialized SL7 seems to raise more questions than it does answers.

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Jem PT | 6 days ago

Not sure of the significance of the old Renault Twingo in the otherwise empty backdrop of the first photo? Some sort of Gallic joke at the expense of former sponser Citroen maybe??

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Jack Sexty replied to [Jem PT](#) | 4 days ago

Just found the juxtaposition intriguing, no subliminal reason! We also did a Twingo vs shiny new pro bike poll on our Instagram story, and 28% preferred the Twingo. Expecting my Pulitzer in the post soon for my work on this story.

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jaysa | 6 days ago

Nice looking bikes and quite sharp stack/reach too ... Small is 531/385, which is 6mm higher than my Oltre for example.

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Rendel Harris | 6 days ago

Having had the 2014 Ultegra Di2 Btwin race bike that was used by AG2R's development squad and the French U19 squad (and having only just sold it as my 55-y-o back can't take a full-on slammed position any longer) I can certainly vouch for the fact that Decathlon are more than capable of building truly excellent top-end machines, good to see them back. Also great to see the departure of the brown shorts!

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kil0ran | 6 days ago

That kit looks fantastic. Should be quite distinctive in the peloton too.

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3 likes



mark1a replied to [kil0ran](#) | 6 days ago

“
kil0ran wrote:
That kit looks fantastic. Should be quite distinctive in the peloton too.

At long last, we'll find out what an explosion in the cycling aisle of a Decathlon store looks like. 🤔🤖

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Rendel Harris replied to [mark1a](#) | 6 days ago

They'll still be wearing terrible ugly clogs though won't they, they wouldn't get into a dinner party in Kent with that clobber on.



3 likes



check12 | 6 days ago

Will be interesting to see the wheels and bars on the ultegra model, the price is quite different so expecting some downgrades or if not, sounds very good value if still expensive

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Rendel Harris replied to [check12](#) | 6 days ago

“
check12 wrote:
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Hard to tell much at the moment as they only have a help/unboxing page for the Ultegra model but from the pictures on there it seems clear it won't come with an integrated stem/bar combo or the Swiss Side Hadron wheels as shown on the team bike.

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philhubbard replied to [Rendel Harris](#) | 5 days ago

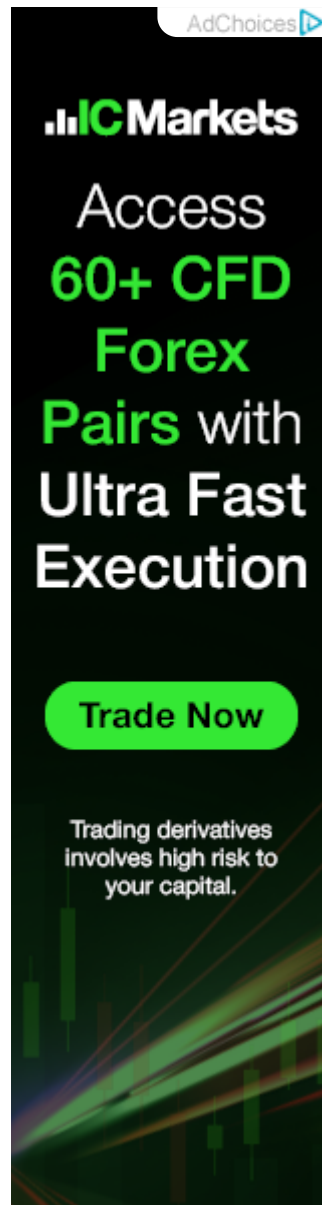
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I imagine it will be the Ultegra C36 carbon wheels and a Deda Superzero bars/stem like in Europe. Personally I would probably pick the standard RCR (non-Pro) with the Zipp 303S and Rival as the best value

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RDaneel 13 min 19 sec ago

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bigwheeler88 17 min 6 sec ago

Why even do it? Only result is that he is getting less training for races and is less likely to win now.

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bigwheeler88 1

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